



Is it enough? Churchill Brothers celebrate the draw with Real Kashmir, which kept the team provisionally on top of the I-League standings. AIFF MEDIA

SHROUD OF CONTROVERSY

Though both Churchill Brothers and Inter Kashi celebrated as if they had won the title, the final seal of approval on **who the I-League champion truly is** rests with the AIFF.

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EXPLAINER

At the end of another photo finish on the final day of the I-League season, pictures emerged of both Churchill Brothers and Inter Kashi simultaneously celebrating their achievement of winning the I-League, leading to confusion all around.

It is not often that a club that finishes a season with the highest points must wait to be officially called champion. But the latest conundrum could see Churchill Brothers denied its third I-League title despite finishing on top.

On April 6, as the whistle blew at the TRC Polo Synthetic Turf Ground in Srinagar, Churchill Brothers had finished the 2024-25 I-League season with 40 points — the highest tally among all the teams.

Elsewhere, Inter Kashi — which won 3-1 against Rajasthan FC — had finished second with 39 points. Yet, its celebrations mimicked those of a champion.

The reason for this is that Inter Kashi is yet to hear from the All India Football Federation (AIFF)